continent. In this lesson we can learn location, boundaries, relief features, rivers, climate, natural vegetation, minerals and transportation.

Location and Area

The continent of North America lies between 7°N and 84°N latitude which lie entirely in the Northern Hemisphere. The Tropic of Cancer(23 ½°N) passes through the Mexico and Arctic Circle (66 ½°N) runs through northern part of Canada. Longitudinally it extends between 53°W and 180°W and lies entirely in the western hemisphere. This continent has a great longitudinal extent which results in Seven Time Zones. North America covers an area of about 24,709,000 Sq. km. Which occupies 16.50 percent of the entire land area.

Boundaries

North America is surrounded by the Pacific Ocean in the West, the Atlantic Ocean in the east, Arctic Ocean in the north and South America in the south. The Isthmus of Panama joined with the North America and South America. The Bering Strait separates North America from Asia.

Political Division

North America is the third largest continent next to Asia and Africa. North America has three large countries and several smaller ones. Canada is the largest country of North America followed by the United States of America and Mexico. The seven small countries which lies to the south of Mexico are referred to as central America. These include Nicaragua, Honduras, Guatemala, Panama, Costa Rica, El Salvador and Belize.

DO YOU KNOW?

Isthmus : A narrow stretch of land joining two large land masses.

Strait: A narrow stretch of water joining two large water bodies.



Political division of North America

Physiography

North America is a continent of great physical diversity. Mount McKinley is about 6194 m above the sea level and is the highest peak. In North America death valley is about 86 m below the sea level and is the lowest part of the continent of North America. It has some of the oldest and the youngest rocks in the world. On the basis of physiography North America can be classified into four major physical divisions:

1. The Rocky Mountains,
2. The Great Plains,
3. The Appalachian Highlands and
4. The Coastal Plain.

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